RANK FILES

COMPLETE ENGLISH GRAMMAR MASTERCLASS — DIRECT & INDIRECT SPEECH (NARRATION)

CLASS X CBSE & COMPETITIVE EXAM SPECIAL GUIDE

1. FUNDAMENTALS OF NARRATION

Narration refers to the art of reporting the words of a speaker. There are two distinct ways to convey what someone said:

- **Direct Speech:** Repeating the exact words spoken by the speaker enclosed in quotation marks.
- **Indirect Speech (Reported Speech):** Reporting the substance of what was said without using the speaker's exact words, making necessary adjustments to pronouns, tenses, and time/place adverbs.

> **Structure of Direct Speech:**
> He said to me, "I am writing a concept note."
> • **Reporting Verb:** *said to* | **Reporting Subject:** *He* | **Reporting Object:** *me*
> • **Reported Speech:** *"I am writing a concept note."*

2. FUNDAMENTAL RULES OF CONVERSION

A. Change of Person (The S-O-N Formula)

The person of the pronoun in reported speech changes based on the **SON / 123** rule:

Rule Code	Reported Speech Pronoun	Changes According To
1 → S	1st Person (I, we, me, my, our)	Subject of the Reporting Verb
2 → O	2nd Person (you, your, yours)	Object of the Reporting Verb
3 → N	3rd Person (he, she, it, they, him, her)	No Change

Direct: She said to me, "You helped my brother."

Indirect: She told me that I had helped her brother.

B. Change of Tenses

Tense change occurs **ONLY** when the reporting verb is in the **Past Tense** (e.g., *said, told, asked*). If the reporting verb is in the Present or Future tense (e.g., *says, will say*), the tense of the reported speech does NOT change.

Direct Speech Tense	Indirect Speech Tense
Simple Present (do/does / V1)	Simple Past (did / V2)
Present Continuous (is/am/are + V-ing)	Past Continuous (was/were + V-ing)
Present Perfect (has/have + V3)	Past Perfect (had + V3)
Present Perfect Continuous (has/have been)	Past Perfect Continuous (had been)
Simple Past (V2 / did)	Past Perfect (had + V3)
Past Continuous (was/were + V-ing)	Past Perfect Continuous (had been + V-ing)
Past Perfect (had + V3)	**No Change** (remains Past Perfect)
Past Perfect Continuous (had been + V-ing)	**No Change** (remains Past Perfect Cont.)

Modal Auxiliary: shall / will	should / would
Modal Auxiliary: can / may	could / might
Modal Auxiliary: must / ought to / should / would / could	**No Change** (or *had to* for 'must' when obligation)

C. Words Expressing Nearness (Time & Distance)

Direct	Indirect	Direct	Indirect
Now	Then	Ago	Before
Today	That day	Tonight	That night
Yesterday	The previous day / day before	Tomorrow	The next day / following day
This / These	That / Those	Here / Hither	There / Thither
Next week/year	The following week/year	Last night	The previous night

3. EXCEPTIONS TO TENSE CHANGES (CRITICAL BOARD EXAM POINTS)

EXCEPTION 1: UNIVERSAL TRUTHS & HABITUAL FACTS

If the reported speech expresses a universal truth, scientific principle, mathematical fact, or habitual action, its tense **NEVER CHANGES** even if the reporting verb is in the past tense.

Direct: The teacher said, "The sun rises in the east."

Indirect: The teacher said that the sun rises in the east. (NOT *rose*)

Direct: He said, "Water boils at 100°C."

Indirect: He said that water boils at 100°C.

EXCEPTION 2: HISTORICAL FACTS

Historical facts remain in their original tense.

Direct: The history teacher said, "Samudragupta is called the Napoleon of India."

Indirect: The history teacher said that Samudragupta is called the Napoleon of India.

EXCEPTION 3: PROVERBIAL EXPRESSIONS

Proverbs and sayings undergo no tense alteration.

Direct: My grandfather said, "Honesty is the best policy."

Indirect: My grandfather said that honesty is the best policy.

EXCEPTION 4: SIMULTANEOUS PAST ACTIONS

When two continuous actions take place simultaneously in the past, their tenses remain unchanged.

Direct: She said, "While I was cooking, my children were playing."

Indirect: She said that while she was cooking, her children were playing.

EXCEPTION 5: PAST UNREAL / HYPOTHETICAL CONDITIONS

Conditional sentences type 2 and type 3 (unreal past, wishful states with *were/had V3*) do not change tense.

Direct: He said, "If I were rich, I would help the needy."

Indirect: He said that if he were rich, he would help the needy.

4. TYPE-WISE SENTENCE CONVERSION

Type 1: Assertive Sentences (Statements)

- **Reporting Verb:** *said → said; said to → told.*
- **Conjunction:** *that*.

Direct: Rohan said to me, "I have completed my work today."

Indirect: Rohan told me that he had completed his work that day.

Type 2: Interrogative Sentences (Questions)

- **Reporting Verb:** *said / said to → asked, inquired of, demanded.*
- **Conjunction:**
  - **Yes/No Questions:** Use *if* or *whether*.
  - **Wh- Questions (who, where, why, how):** Use the same question word (no extra conjunction like *that*).
- **Sentence Structure:** Convert question structure back to statement structure (Subject + Verb). Remove question mark (?).

Direct (Yes/No): She said to him, "Are you coming to school today?"

Indirect: She asked him if he was coming to school that day.

Direct (Wh-): The officer said to the boy, "Why are you crying?"

Indirect: The officer asked the boy why he was crying.

EXCEPTION / SPECIAL CASE: QUESTION TAGS

Drop the question tag and frame the sentence with *if / whether*.

Direct: He said to me, "You like tea, don't you?"

Indirect: He asked me if I liked tea.

Type 3: Imperative Sentences (Commands, Requests, Advice)

- **Reporting Verb:** *said to → ordered, commanded, requested, advised, suggested, forbade, warned.*
- **Conjunction / Infinitive:** Replace quotation marks with *to* + V1. For negative imperatives ("Don't"), use *not to* + V1 or *forbade* + *to* + V1.

Direct (Order): The doctor said to the patient, "Take this medicine twice a day."

Indirect: The doctor advised the patient to take that medicine twice a day.

Direct (Negative): The teacher said to the student, "Do not waste your time."

Indirect: The teacher advised the student not to waste his time. OR The teacher forbade the student to waste his time.

SPECIAL CASE: SENTENCES STARTING WITH "LET"

- **Proposal / Suggestion ("Let us / Let's"):** Change reporting verb to *proposed to / suggested to*. Conjunction: *that* + Subject + *should* + V1.
- **Permission ("Let me / Let him"):** Change reporting verb to *requested / allowed*. Use *to let* or *that* + *subject* + *might be allowed to*.

Direct: Mohan said to his friends, "Let us go for a picnic."

Indirect: Mohan proposed to his friends that they should go for a picnic.

Direct: The clerk said to the officer, "Let me check the file."

Indirect: The clerk requested the officer to let him check the file.

Type 4: Exclamatory Sentences (Expressing Sudden Feelings)

- **Reporting Verb:** *exclaimed with joy, exclaimed with sorrow, exclaimed with surprise, exclaimed with anger, applauded by saying.*
- **Conjunction:** *that.*
- Remove exclamation mark (!) and convert interjections (Hurrah, Alas, Wow, Oh) into appropriate emotions.

Direct: The captain said, "Hurrah! We have won the match."

Indirect: The captain exclaimed with joy that they had won the match.

Direct: She said, "Alas! My dog is dead."

Indirect: She exclaimed with sorrow that her dog was dead.

Direct: He said, "What a beautiful flower it is!"

Indirect: He exclaimed with wonder that it was a very beautiful flower.

Type 5: Optative Sentences (Wishes, Prayers, Blessings, Curses)

- **Reporting Verb:** *wished, prayed, blessed, cursed.*
- **Conjunction:** *that.*
- Auxiliary verb *may* changes to *might* and moves after the subject.

Direct: The old lady said to me, "May God bless you!"

Indirect: The old lady prayed that God might bless me.

Direct: The audience said, "Long live the King!"

Indirect: The audience prayed/wished that the King might live long.

5. ADVANCED CONCEPTS & TRICKY EXCEPTIONS

1. Use of "Must" in Indirect Speech:
- If *must* expresses universal duty, moral principle, or permanent rule → **No Change**.
- If *must* expresses present obligation → Changes to **had to**.
- If *must* expresses future obligation → Changes to **would have to**.

Direct: He said, "We must obey parents." → **Indirect:** He said that we must obey parents.

Direct: She said, "I must leave now." → **Indirect:** She said that she had to leave then.

2. Greetings, Farewells, and Expressions of Thanks:
- *"Good morning / Good day"* → Use **wished**.
- *"Good night / Goodbye / Farewell"* → Use **bade**.
- *"Thank you"* → Convert into main verb **thanked**.
- *"Congratulations"* → Convert into main verb **congratulated**.

Direct: He said to me, "Good morning, my friend." → **Indirect:** He wished his friend good morning.

Direct: Anand said to Sohan, "Thank you for your help." → **Indirect:** Anand thanked Sohan for his help.

3. Dialogue & Multi-Sentence Conversions:
When a speech contains multiple consecutive sentences (e.g. a statement followed by a question), join them using appropriate connectives like *and added that, and further asked.*

Direct: Rohit said, "I cannot attend the class today. Am I allowed to leave early?"

Indirect: Rohit said that he could not attend the class that day and asked if he was allowed to leave early.